

PELICAN BAY POLICE DEPARTMENT
HOMICIDE DIVISION — EIGHTH DISTRICT

715 South Broad Avenue, New Orleans, LA 70119
(504) 658-6080

WITNESS STATEMENT — DARNELL WASHINGTON

Case No.: PBPD-2025-088142 | Document No.: 13

Witness:	DARNELL WASHINGTON
Race/Sex/DOB:	M/B, April 2, 1984 (Age 41)
Occupation:	Riverboat Tour Operator, New Orleans Steamboat Company
Residence:	718 Bourbon Street, Apt. 4, New Orleans, LA 70116
Statement Date:	October 4, 2025
Statement Time:	6:45 AM – 7:30 AM
Location:	PBPD Eighth District Station, Interview Room 3
Interviewing Detective:	Det. Renee Broussard, Badge #1887
Case Number:	PBPD-2025-088142

[BEGIN TRANSCRIBED STATEMENT]

I live above Magnolia Spirits at 718 Bourbon. Been there six years. I work the riverboats, day shifts mostly, so I'm up late most nights. My landlord's got a no-smoking policy in the building, which I respect but don't enjoy, so I go down to the alley door on the side to smoke most nights. It's a habit. Been doing it for years.

Last night — Friday night going into Saturday — I went down around 1 AM, maybe a little after. The alley was quiet when I first got there. I was leaning in the doorway, smoking. You can see down the alley pretty good from that doorway, maybe thirty feet in each direction.

Around — I'd say 1:20, give or take — I heard a door bang open. The staff door for The Rusty Anchor. It's metal, makes a hell of a sound when it swings hard. Three men came out. They were white guys. Moving fast, moving with purpose — not like they were leaving, more like they were going somewhere specific. You know the difference. I've lived on Bourbon Street long enough.

I couldn't see their faces good. The light in that alley is terrible — there's one bulb at the far end near Bourbon Street and that's about it. The area around the staff door is dark. I could see their general shapes and colors. One of them had on a red shirt — short sleeve. One had something darker on top, like a jacket maybe. Third one I couldn't make out.

They went east down the alley, away from me. They were talking but not loud enough for me to hear words. After a minute or two I heard raised voices. Then I heard something — like a heavy sound, thudding. Couldn't tell you exactly what it was. Could've been a lot of things. On Bourbon Street late on a Friday you hear all kinds.

I finished my cigarette and went back inside. I didn't think much of it. About an hour later there were sirens and I looked out my window and saw the police lights. That's when I went back down.

Detective Broussard: Can you identify any of the three men?

Darnell Washington: I want to be honest with you — no. I can't make a definitive ID. It was dark and I wasn't paying real close attention. Three white men, one red shirt, one darker top. That's what I've got. I don't want to say more than I actually saw.

Detective Broussard: Could you estimate age or build?

Darnell Washington: Young. Late twenties, early thirties. Average builds — none of them was particularly big. The one in the red shirt might've been the biggest of the three but I'm guessing at that point.

[END STATEMENT]

DETECTIVE NOTE: Washington's description of a man in a red short-sleeve shirt is consistent with Travis Bell's confirmed attire per indoor bar surveillance (red short-sleeve shirt). Washington's account of three men exiting the staff door at approximately 1:20 AM is consistent with indoor camera footage showing all three suspects exiting at 1:18 AM. Washington's report of 'thudding sounds' is consistent with blunt force assault.

Witness Signature: _____ Darnell Washington
Detective Signature: _____ Renee Broussard #1887
Date: October 4, 2025